

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Senior Private Client Solicitor position at Gardner Leader. Although this role requires a qualified solicitor, I want to draw your attention to my background in case preparation, client communication and document drafting in case you have paralegal or legal assistant openings within the Private Client team, or in case this application is of use for future recruitment.

My year at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner gave me direct experience of managing complex matters under pressure. In the Real Estate Disputes team I prepared hearing bundles, maintained matter records on iManage, tracked deadlines across several concurrent files, and supported skeleton arguments and court filings. In the International Arbitration team I took on sole responsibility for coordinating documents and tracking outstanding actions shortly before a major submission deadline, which required both careful organisation and sound judgement about priorities.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire I now advise clients on welfare benefits, housing, family and debt matters. I take detailed factual statements, draft correspondence and applications, and explain complex procedural rules clearly to people who are often in difficult circumstances. Working with vulnerable clients on sensitive matters has sharpened my ability to communicate carefully and to manage expectations honestly, skills that are central to private client work.

Gardner Leader's Thames Valley base and its reputation for private client work make it a natural fit for where I want to develop. I live in Maidenhead and am familiar with the firm's presence locally. My LLM dissertation examined data protection across jurisdictions, and my LLB included modules in company and commercial law, so I have a grounding in the academic framework that underpins estate planning and related advisory work, even though I have not yet practised in private client directly.

If you do not currently have a suitable opening, I would welcome the chance to be considered for any paralegal vacancy in the Private Client team as it arises.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva